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ERICSSON

CHALLENGE BY ERICSSON

Data Storage Optimization

Build a tool that frees up storage without losing information: turn long recordings and documents into compact, searchable, AI-ready data, and find duplicates across systems.

> Ericsson's note: this challenge can be solved without sharing sensitive data, and partial solutions can reach the goal. From there, it can grow as big as you like.

THE CHALLENGE

We want a tool that supports efficient use of data storage, so we can clean out large files but still keep their information at minimum cost. It addresses two issues:

- Storage reduction: replace content such as video with text and key frames, and identify duplicates.
- Data activation: make content searchable and consumable by AI.

The solution can include distilling data, compressing files and identifying duplicate information across systems. In addition, when someone leaves the company, their files should be analysed, compared with existing copies and deleted only if a duplicate already exists.

WHAT TO PRESENT IN THE FINAL PITCH

Solve the main issues: save storage, make content searchable and feed AI. In your pitch, present:

1. Which use cases you addressed.
2. How you solved the challenges technically.
3. Scenario-based percentage savings in data volume.
4. A possible data strategy that is future-proof and supports a data-driven AI approach.
5. Potential areas for further work, and any problems that remain unresolved.

BACKGROUND

Ericsson stores and produces a large number of presentations, screen recordings and videos from internal meetings, courses and more. A single recording can be several hours long and often hundreds of megabytes. These recordings take up storage on every platform they live on: SharePoint sites, OneDrive and the third-party platform Ericsson Play.

Because the files are so large, highly informative content is often deleted for lack of storage. Documents on internal sites are also downloaded to laptops and uploaded again to different people's OneDrives, which creates duplicates.

As regulations were enforced, site administrators and owners had to start deleting content from SharePoint sites when they reached maximum storage. Permanent deletion loses all the information in those files, at a time when data is considered the new gold. Deleted files can no longer be used as training data for future AI models. If recordings needed less storage, more of them could be kept for longer, stay accessible to employees and be used to train AI agents and models.

THE BASIC IDEA

A new tool could transform video content into other forms of data, such as text files and single image frames, for example of a PowerPoint slide. The information in a video becomes text, which is much easier for AI models to digest. Turning certain types of video into clean text data makes future internal AI agents stronger and gives current internal models new data to learn from.

Video needs far more storage than text, images or audio. Compressing meeting recordings into smaller pieces of data lowers storage costs and makes recordings faster to share and upload. A realistic scenario: a 2-hour recording (~1 GB) becomes ~50 KB of text plus ~2 MB of slide frames, roughly a 99% reduction, while keeping the information that matters.

New recordings may have transcripts if transcription was switched on during recording. Older files don't, and existing transcripts aren't linked to what is shown on screen.

SUGGESTED USE CASES

In a recording, capture the text:

1. As plain text.
2. …with each speaker identified.

Capture a frame of a slide in a video, at any of these levels of complexity:

1. A screenshot.
2. …that is compressed.
3. …or is identified by document number and slide number.
4. …and identified and linked to a single source of truth.
5. …or described in a text prompt so the slide can be recreated.

- A recorded event compressed into plain ASCII text, an image, a unique slide identifier or a voice sample.
- Extracted text time-linked to the frame, so a phrase like “as you see here” still makes sense.
- A search for a subject returns the matching frame and text.
- Based on all this data, can the recording be recreated as a video?

For documents (files, presentations and slides):

- How can duplicated data be identified and handled?
- Can PDFs and PowerPoints be broken down into slides, with each slide given a hash as an identifier, so identical slides can be compared quickly? Optional information could include document number and file name.

- How should presentations with several revisions, each with only minor changes to a slide, be handled?

SAMPLE MATERIAL

Ericsson will provide example files, including but not limited to:

- MP4 recordings of an event.
- PDFs presented at the event.
- A duplicate of the presentations, with the downloader adding a suffix such as “(1).pdf”.
- Presentations that share some slides.

Presentations can have metadata such as document number, revision, author and date.

Questions? Ask the organizers, ambassadors, coaches, partners or jury members for help, they're there to support you.
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